

Lorraine Travel — SEO, AEO & GEO Optimization Proposal

Oct 5, 2026 · @Vincent Lancin

1. Executive Summary

Lorraine Travel's site is technically sound but under-optimized: our 2026-10-05 audit scored it about **78/100**, with no critical blockers and a short list of high-impact fixes that can be completed inside 30 days. This proposal turns that audit into a continuous system: **identify, prioritize, implement, track, measure, optimize** across SEO (Google), AEO (answer engines) and GEO (AI-generated results).

Where the site stands

- All 36 sitemap URLs return 200, with self-referencing canonicals, one H1 per page and no duplicate titles.
- Schema is already strong (Organization, TravelAgency, FAQPage, Article, BreadcrumbList), and `llms.txt` plus AI-crawler access are in place.
- The gaps are fixable: the bare domain's HTTPS appears to fail, 9 destination guides share one meta description, there are no security headers, and 15 titles and 14 descriptions are over length.
- The bigger opportunity is growth: destination guides are only 350-450 words, the blog has 4 posts, and Lorraine's 1948 heritage, Four Seasons Preferred Partner status and advisor expertise are under-used as entity and citation signals.

What we will deliver

- A 30-day critical fix plan and a 90-day growth roadmap, each task scored by priority, impact and effort.
- Daily, weekly and monthly monitoring routines.
- A permanent tracker as the single source of truth, with weekly updates and a monthly KPI report that ties completed work to results.

What we will not do: promise specific rankings. Targets are set against a measured baseline (Google Search Console and Semrush data once access is granted) and reviewed monthly.

Basis and limits: the audit used raw HTML from 36 URLs. Core Web Vitals, Search Console, GA4, backlinks, Google Business Profile and AI-citation data are not yet measured; they are the first items on the access list in Section 11.

2. Current Situation / Audit Findings

The site passes the basics of crawlability and structured data; its weaknesses are metadata quality, missing security headers, one possible domain-level HTTPS fault, and thin supporting content. Evidence below comes from the 2026-10-05 audit of www.lorrainetravel.com (homepage, robots.txt, sitemap.xml, llms.txt and all 36 sitemap URLs).

Area	Finding	Evidence
Crawling / indexing	Healthy	36 of 36 URLs return 200; real 404 for missing pages; robots: index, follow, max-image-preview:large
Canonicals	Healthy	Self-referencing on all 36 pages; http redirects 301 to https://www
Robots.txt / sitemap	Healthy, one weakness	Allows all crawlers incl. GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot; sitemap lastmod is 2026-10-05 on every URL, so it carries no change signal
Domain HTTPS	Needs verification	https://lorrainetravel.com fails TLS handshake from the audit sandbox; https://www works
Metadata	Weak	9 destination pages share one 59-character description; 14 descriptions over 160 characters (max 245); 15 titles over 60 characters (max 89)
Headings / duplicates	Healthy	One H1 per page; no duplicate titles
Schema	Strong	Organization, TravelAgency, Place/GeoCoordinates, OpeningHours, WebSite+SearchAction, FAQPage, Offer; Article + BreadcrumbList on guides

Area	Finding	Evidence
Security headers	Missing	No HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options in the homepage response
Performance	Promising, unmeasured	0.15-0.55 s response, 57 KB homepage, 14 of 16 images lazy-loaded; no Core Web Vitals data yet
Images	Minor gaps	2 homepage images and 1-2 images on most pages lack alt text
Content depth	Thin in places	Destination guides 353-455 words; /resources/climate 251 words; 4 blog posts
AI readiness	Strong foundation	llms.txt with address, phone, affiliations and specialties; strong E-E-A-T signals (1948 founding, family-owned, Four Seasons Preferred Partner, Signature Travel, ASTA)

Rankings baseline: not yet available. The Semrush connection ran out of API units, and Search Console data has not been shared. Collecting a keyword, impressions and position baseline is Task 1 of the 30-day plan, and every ranking target in Section 9 is set after that baseline exists.

Not yet assessed: Core Web Vitals (INP, LCP, CLS), JavaScript rendering, mobile screenshots, backlink profile, Google Business Profile, reviews and citations, internal link graph, and AI-citation presence.

3. Main SEO, AEO and GEO Opportunities

The largest opportunity is turning Lorraine's real authority (1948, family-owned, preferred-partner access, named advisors) into pages that rank, answer questions directly and get cited by AI systems.

Discipline	Opportunity	Why it matters here
SEO	Rewrite metadata on 9 destination pages, trim 15 titles and 14 descriptions	Cheapest high-impact win; affects snippet quality and CTR on every page

Discipline	Opportunity	Why it matters here
SEO	Expand 9 destination guides from ~400 to 900-1,500 words with itineraries, seasons, properties and advisor commentary	These pages target "luxury Maldives", "best hotels Paris"-type queries with the most commercial value
SEO	Build hub-and-spoke clusters (Destinations, Cruises, Hotels, Honeymoons, Safaris) with internal links	30 homepage links and 4 blog posts leave topical depth unclaimed
SEO	Local SEO for Coral Gables / Miami / South Florida: Google Business Profile, citations, reviews, location signals	Brick-and-mortar agency; GBP and map-pack visibility are unmeasured
SEO	Authority links: Four Seasons, Signature Travel, ASTA, destination boards, press and heritage stories	The 1948 Havana-to-Coral Gables story is link-worthy and unique
AEO	Direct-answer blocks (40-60 words) and expanded FAQs under every destination, cruise and hotel page	FAQPage schema exists on the homepage only; question queries ("best time to visit...") are unclaimed
AEO	Featured-snippet formats: comparison tables, checklists, "best time to go" tables	The <code>/compare</code> page and resource pages already suit these formats
AEO	Extend FAQPage, HowTo-style and Review/Offer markup site-wide, validated	Schema foundation is already strong; extending it is low effort
GEO	Entity consistency: name, address, phone, founders, history, affiliations identical across site, GBP, directories, Wikidata-style profiles	AI systems cite entities they can verify across sources
GEO	Citation-worthy content: original advisor guidance, dated facts, named authors with credentials, sourced statistics	Raises the chance of being quoted in AI Overviews, ChatGPT search and Copilot
GEO	Maintain and expand <code>11ms.txt</code> , keep AI crawlers allowed, add a <code>/press</code> or <code>/facts</code> page	Foundation is in place; keep it accurate and current

Discipline	Opportunity	Why it matters here
GEO	Track brand mentions and citations on Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Bing Copilot	Currently unmeasured; needed to prove results

4. Critical Issues

No issue found so far blocks indexing site-wide, but three High items and four Medium items should be fixed first because they combine high impact with low or medium effort. The scoring rules (Priority, Impact, Effort) are defined at the end of Section 9.

#	Issue	Priority	Impact	Effort
1	https://lorrainetravel.com (no www) fails TLS handshake from the audit sandbox; must be verified from a normal network	High	High	Low
2	9 destination pages share the meta description "Editorial travel guide written by Lorraine Travel advisors."	High	High	Low
3	No ranking, impressions or Core Web Vitals baseline (Search Console, GA4, Semrush not connected)	High	High	Low
4	14 meta descriptions over 160 characters; 15 titles over 60 characters	Medium	Medium	Low
5	No security headers (HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy)	Medium	Medium	Medium
6	Sitemap <code>lastmod</code> identical (2026-10-05) on every URL	Medium	Medium	Low
7	Thin destination guides (353-455 words) and thin resource pages (251-464 words)	Medium	High	High
8	Missing alt text on 2 homepage images and 1-2 images per page elsewhere	Low	Low	Low

5. 30-Day Action Plan

The 30-day plan runs 2026-10-06 to 2026-11-04 and covers 18 tasks, ordered by priority, then impact, then effort. Owners: **SEO** = our team, **Dev** = client's developer or Cloudflare admin, **Client** = client-side stakeholder. Every task starts as "Not started" and moves through the statuses in Section 8.

#	Issue identified	Recommended action	Priority	Expected impact	Owner	Target date	Status	KPI affected
1	No performance baseline	Get Search Console, GA4, Bing Webmaster and Semrush access; export 16 months of queries, pages, clicks, impressions, position; record a 50-100 keyword baseline	High	Enables every target and report	SEO + Client	2026-10-09	Waiting for Client	All KPIs
2	Bare-domain HTTPS fails TLS handshake (sandbox result)	Test from 3 networks; if confirmed, fix Cloudflare certificate for the apex and 301 to https://www	High	Prevents lost visits and link equity	Dev	2026-10-13	Not started	Organic clicks, indexed pages
3	9 destination pages share one meta description	Write unique 120-155 character descriptions with destination, hook and CTA; align og:description	High	Better CTR on top commercial pages	SEO	2026-10-16	Not started	CTR, impressions

#	Issue identified	Recommended action	Priority	Expected impact	Owner	Target date	Status	KPI affected
4	Titles over 60 characters (15 pages, homepage 75)	Rewrite to 50-60 characters, brand last, primary keyword first	Medium	Cleaner SERP titles, higher CTR	SEO	2026-10-16	Not started	CTR
5	Descriptions over 160 characters (14 pages, max 245)	Trim to 140-155 characters with one benefit and one CTA	Medium	Prevents truncation	SEO	2026-10-20	Not started	CTR
6	Core Web Vitals not measured	Run PageSpeed Insights and CrUX on homepage plus top 10 pages, mobile and desktop; log LCP, INP, CLS	High	Establishes performance baseline, finds fixes	SEO	2026-10-16	Not started	CWV pass rate
7	Mobile usability unverified	Capture mobile screenshots and Search Console mobile report; test tap targets, menu, forms on top 10 pages	High	Protects mobile rankings and conversion	SEO	2026-10-20	Not started	Mobile CWV, conversions
8	No security headers	Add HSTS, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy, X-Frame-Options / CSP frame-ancestors, Permissions-Policy via Cloudflare or app	Medium	Trust and security hygiene	Dev	2026-10-30	Not started	Technical health score

#	Issue identified	Recommended action	Priority	Expected impact	Owner	Target date	Status	KPI affected
9	Sitemap lastmod stamped to build date	Set lastmod to real last-modified dates; resubmit in Search Console and Bing	Medium	Better crawl prioritization	Dev	2026-10-23	Not started	Indexed pages, crawl stats
10	Indexing status of all 36 URLs unknown	Inspect URLs in Search Console; resolve any "discovered / crawled, not indexed"	High	Confirms all pages are eligible to rank	SEO	2026-10-23	Not started	Indexed pages
11	Broken links / redirects not fully crawled	Run a full crawl (all internal links, images, outbound); fix 4xx/5xx and redirect chains	High	Cleaner crawl, preserved link equity	SEO + Dev	2026-10-23	Not started	Crawl errors, indexed pages
12	Duplicate and canonical risk (www/non-www, trailing slash, parameters)	Verify one canonical host and path pattern; check parameter URLs	Medium	Avoids split signals	SEO	2026-10-23	Not started	Indexed pages
13	Schema validated only by pattern	Validate all templates in Rich Results Test and Schema Validator; fix errors; add Article author and dates, BreadcrumbList on all guides	Medium	Rich-result eligibility	SEO	2026-10-27	Not started	Valid structured data
14	Missing alt text on images	Add descriptive alt text to all images flagged (2 on homepage first)	Low	Image search, accessibility	SEO + Client	2026-10-27	Not started	Image impressions

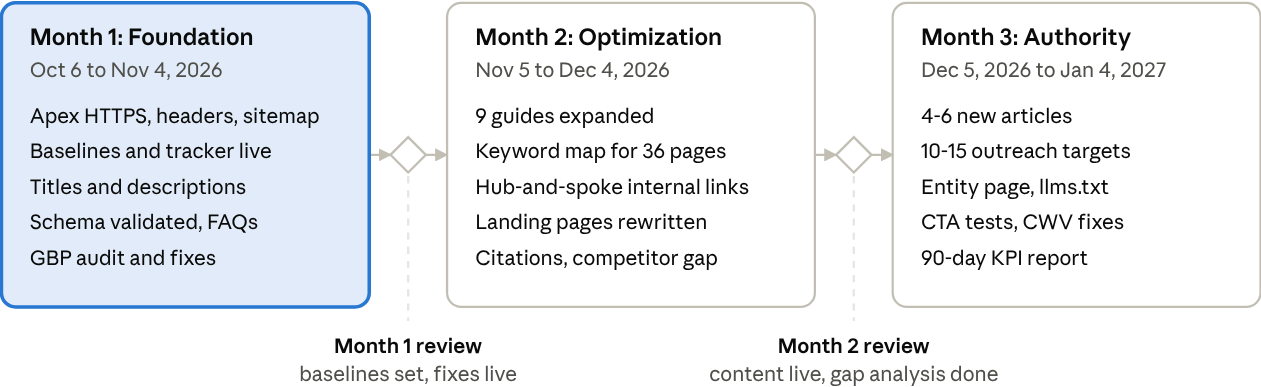
#	Issue identified	Recommended action	Priority	Expected impact	Owner	Target date	Status	KPI affected
15	No AI-visibility baseline	Test 25 priority questions in Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT search, Perplexity and Copilot; log whether Lorraine is cited	High	Baseline for GEO targets	SEO	2026-10-20	Not started	AI citations, brand mentions
16	FAQ schema only on homepage	Add 5-8 question-and-answer blocks with FAQPage markup to the top 5 destination and service pages	Medium	AEO and featured-snippet eligibility	SEO + Client	2026-10-30	Not started	Snippets, AI citations
17	Google Business Profile unverified	Audit GBP: categories, NAP, hours, services, photos, reviews, Q&A	High	Local pack visibility	SEO + Client	2026-10-27	Waiting for Client	GBP views, calls
18	Tracker and reporting not set up	Build the SEO / AEO / GEO tracker (Section 8), import all findings, send first weekly update	High	Single source of truth	SEO	2026-10-12	Not started	Reporting cadence

30-day outcome: baseline captured, every metadata and technical fix in place, schema validated, AI visibility measured, and a 90-day plan adjusted to real data. Tasks 1, 2, 3, 15 and 18 are the first-week priority.

6. 90-Day Roadmap

Month 1 fixes the foundation, Month 2 optimizes and expands content, Month 3 builds authority and measures growth. Each month ends with a review that can change the next month's plan.

Foundation first, then content, then authority



90-day roadmap · 3 phases, 2 review gates

Each month ends with a review gate; if the data says so, the next month's plan changes before work starts.

Month 1 (2026-10-06 to 2026-11-04): Foundation and Critical Fixes

Workstream	Completed by end of month
Technical	Apex HTTPS fixed, security headers live, sitemap lastmod corrected, crawl errors and redirect chains resolved, canonical rules verified
Measurement	Search Console, GA4, Bing Webmaster, Semrush connected; 50-100 keyword baseline; Core Web Vitals and AI-visibility baselines logged; tracker live
On-page	All titles and descriptions rewritten; 9 destination descriptions unique; alt text fixed
Schema / AEO	All schema validated; FAQ blocks and FAQPage markup on top 5 pages
Local	Google Business Profile audited and corrected

Month 2 (2026-11-05 to 2026-12-04): Optimization and Expansion

Workstream	Completed by end of month
Content	9 destination guides expanded to 900-1,500 words with direct-answer intro, "best time to go" table, FAQs, named advisor author; /resources/* pages brought above 600 words
Keywords	Keyword map for all 36 pages plus 30-50 new target queries (destination, cruise line, hotel brand, honeymoon, family, safari intent)
Internal linking	Hub-and-spoke links between destinations, cruises, hotels and blog; descriptive anchors; every page within 3 clicks
Landing pages	/luxury-vacations, /cruises, /hotels, /special-offers rewritten for intent, with clear consultation CTA and trust signals
AEO	FAQs and direct answers on cruise, hotel and corporate pages; comparison tables targeting featured snippets (/compare)
Schema	Article author and Person markup, Review/Offer where compliant, BreadcrumbList site-wide
Local	Citation clean-up across 20-30 directories; review-request process started; location signals on contact page
Competitor gap	Gap analysis against 5 competitors: keywords, content, links, AI citations

Month 3 (2026-12-05 to 2027-01-04): Authority, Growth and Performance

Workstream	Completed by end of month
Content	4-6 new pillar or blog articles from the gap analysis (e.g. cruise-line comparisons, destination timing guides); 1 original data or advisor-insight piece

Workstream	Completed by end of month
Authority	10-15 outreach targets contacted: Four Seasons / partner pages, Signature Travel, ASTA, destination boards, travel press; heritage story pitched
GEO / entity	Entity facts page (/about or /facts) with founders, dates, affiliations; 11ms.txt refreshed; consistent NAP and brand description across profiles
Conversion	Organic landing pages A/B-tested for CTA and form; call/text/email tracking set up in GA4
Performance	CWV fixes on slowest templates; second AI-visibility test and ranking review
Review	90-day KPI report, results vs. baseline, 6-month plan

7. Ongoing Daily, Weekly and Monthly Strategy

After Month 3 the work becomes a permanent rhythm: daily checks catch problems, weekly work improves pages, monthly review decides strategy.

Daily monitoring (automated alerts where possible, 10-15 minutes)

- Website availability and SSL status, including both www and non-www.
- Search Console alerts, security or manual-action messages and indexing errors.
- Crawl or server errors in Cloudflare and Search Console.
- Sudden drops in organic traffic, impressions or tracked-keyword positions (flag a drop above 20% vs. the 7-day average).
- Robots.txt, sitemap and schema not accidentally changed after a site release.

Weekly activities

- Search Console review: queries, pages, CTR, new and lost impressions.
- Ranking monitoring for the tracked keyword set; note movers above 3 positions.
- Keyword performance: pages ranking 4-15 for a quick-win update.
- Indexing checks on new or changed URLs.
- Page optimization: update 2-4 pages (metadata, content, FAQs, internal links).

- Technical checks: new 404s, redirect chains, Core Web Vitals regressions.
- Competitor monitoring: new pages, rankings and links for the 5 tracked competitors.
- AI-search visibility: re-test 10 priority questions across Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT search, Perplexity and Copilot.
- New content opportunities from queries, People Also Ask and advisor questions.
- Internal linking opportunities for new pages.
- Send the weekly progress update (Section 10).

Monthly activities

- Full SEO performance review against KPI targets (Section 9).
- KPI report: clicks, impressions, CTR, position, conversions, CWV, AI citations.
- Content performance: winners, decliners, pages to refresh or merge.
- Competitor analysis: keywords, content and link gaps.
- Backlink review: new and lost referring domains, toxic links, outreach results.
- Technical health review: full crawl, schema, headers, sitemap, robots.txt.
- AEO / GEO visibility review: featured snippets, AI citations, brand mentions, entity consistency.
- Strategy adjustments and a re-ranked tracker backlog.
- New growth opportunities: seasonal content, new destinations, partner promotions.

8. SEO / AEO / GEO Tracker Structure

The tracker is one shared spreadsheet (Google Sheets or Smartsheet) that records every issue and opportunity from discovery to measured result, so the client can see what was created, updated, fixed, monitored, in progress and completed. Nothing is worked on unless it is a row in the tracker.

Master task columns (every tab that holds tasks uses these)

Column	Purpose
Date identified	When the issue or opportunity was found
Website / project	Domain or sub-project
Page URL	Affected URL or template

Column	Purpose
Category	Technical, Content, Schema, Local, Backlinks, AEO, GEO, Performance
Issue / opportunity	One-line title
Description	Evidence and why it matters
Priority	Critical, High, Medium, Low
Impact / Effort	High, Medium, Low each; used to order the backlog
Recommended action	Specific fix
Assigned to	SEO team, client, developer
Date started / Target completion / Date completed	Timeline
Status	See below
Before metrics / After metrics	Value of the KPI before and 30 days after the change
KPI affected	Clicks, impressions, CTR, position, indexed pages, CWV, leads, AI citations
Google Search Console status	Not checked, Submitted, Validated, Error
Indexing status	Indexed, Not indexed, Pending, Excluded
Ranking / keyword	Primary keyword and position
Notes	Context, links, screenshots
Follow-up date	When the result is re-measured

Statuses: Identified, Planned, In Progress, Waiting for Client, Waiting for Developer, Testing, Monitoring, Completed.

Tabs

Tab	What it holds
Technical SEO	Crawl, indexing, redirects, headers, sitemap, robots.txt, Core Web Vitals, mobile
Content SEO	Page rewrites, new pages, FAQs, internal links, metadata
Keywords and Rankings	Tracked keywords, volume, target URL, position by week, SERP features
Google Search Console	Weekly clicks, impressions, CTR, position; indexing and coverage issues; submitted URLs
AEO / GEO Opportunities	Question targets, snippet opportunities, AI-citation tests by platform, entity consistency checks
Schema / Structured Data	Template, schema type, validation status, errors, rich-result eligibility
Backlinks	Referring domains, outreach targets, status, anchor, link value, lost links
Local SEO	GBP edits, citations, NAP consistency, reviews, local rankings
Competitor Tracking	5 competitors: keywords, content, links, AI citations, changes noticed
Completed Work	Everything finished, with before and after metrics and the KPI it moved
KPI Dashboard	Monthly KPIs vs. baseline and target; trend charts; auto-fed from the tabs above

When a task reaches Completed, its row is copied to Completed Work and a follow-up date is set 30 days later to record the after metrics. That is how activity gets linked to results.

9. KPIs and Performance Targets

No ranking is guaranteed. Targets below are directional: ranges are proposed now and each metric is fixed as "baseline + X%" once Search Console, GA4 and AI-visibility baselines exist in Week 1-2. Targets are reviewed every month.

KPI	Baseline	30 days	90 days	6 months	Long term (12+ months)
Organic impressions	Set Week 1 from GSC	Baseline set; no loss	+10-20%	+30-50%	+75-100%
Organic clicks	Set Week 1	Baseline set; no loss	+10-15%	+25-40%	+60-100%
CTR	Set Week 1	+0.2-0.5 pt on 9 destination pages	+10-15% relative	+20-25% relative	Above category benchmark
Average position	Set Week 1	Stable	Improve 1-2 positions on target pages	Improve 3-5 positions on target pages	Sustained top-10 on core terms
Ranking keywords	Set Week 1 (tracked set of 50-100)	Baseline set	+15-25%	+40-60%	2x baseline
Top 3 / Top 10 rankings	Set Week 1	Baseline set	+3-5 Top 10; +1-2 Top 3	+10-15 Top 10; +4-6 Top 3	Brand and core destination terms in Top 3
Indexed pages	36 submitted; indexed count unknown	100% of eligible pages indexed	100% plus new content indexed within 7 days	Scale with content (50-70 pages)	100+ pages, 95%+ indexed
Valid structured data	Detected, unvalidated	100% valid, 0 errors	Rich-result eligible on FAQ, Article, Breadcrumb	Expanded schema, 0 errors	Maintained at 0 errors
Organic traffic (sessions)	Set Week 1 from GA4	Baseline set	+10-15%	+25-40%	+60-100%
Organic leads / conversions	Set Week 1 (calls, forms, texts)	Tracking verified	+10%	+20-30%	+50-75%
Conversion rate from organic	Set Week 1	Baseline set	+5-10% relative	+15% relative	+25% relative

KPI	Baseline	30 days	90 days	6 months	Long term (12+ months)
Local search visibility	Set Week 2 (local grid)	GBP audited and fixed	Map-pack presence for 3-5 local queries	Top-3 on priority local queries	Sustained map-pack leadership
GBP visibility	Set Week 2 (views, calls, directions)	Profile complete	+10-20%	+25-40%	+50%
Core Web Vitals	Set Week 1 (field data)	Baseline and fix list	Pass on mobile for top 10 pages	90%+ URLs pass	Maintain pass
Referring domains	Set Week 2	Baseline	+5-8 quality domains	+15-25	+40-60
Featured snippets	Set Week 2 (tracked set)	Baseline	1-3	4-8	10+
AI citations and mentions	25-question test, Week 2	Baseline set	Cited in +20% more tests	Cited in +40% more tests	Regular citation for core brand and destination queries
Brand / entity visibility in AI results	Set Week 2	Entity facts consistent everywhere	Accurate brand summary in 3 of 4 AI platforms	Accurate on all tested platforms	Recognized as a leading luxury travel advisor

Prioritization framework. Every task is scored on three scales. **Priority** (Critical, High, Medium, Low) says how urgent it is: Critical blocks indexing or causes penalties and is fixed immediately; High significantly affects rankings and is fixed within a week; Medium is an optimization within a month; Low is backlog. **Impact** (High, Medium, Low) is the expected KPI movement. **Effort** (High, Medium, Low) is the work needed. Order of work: High impact with Low or Medium effort first, then High impact with High effort (scheduled), then Medium impact with Low effort, and Low impact last.

10. Reporting System

The client gets a short weekly update and a full monthly report, both generated from the tracker so every number traces back to a task.

Report	When	Contents
Weekly progress update	Every Monday	Tasks completed and in progress; issues discovered; ranking and traffic movement vs. last week; Search Console highlights; AI / AEO / GEO visibility notes; upcoming priorities; items needing client approval; items needing developer action
Monthly SEO performance report	By the 5th business day	KPI table vs. baseline and target; completed work with before / after metrics; clicks, impressions, CTR, positions; traffic and conversions; Core Web Vitals; backlinks; featured snippets; AI citations and brand mentions; competitor movement; what worked and what did not; next month's plan
Quarterly strategy review	Months 3, 6, 9, 12	Results vs. 90-day, 6-month and long-term goals; strategy changes; budget and resource needs
Urgent alert	Within 1 business day	Traffic drop above 20%, site outage, manual action, indexing loss, SSL or robots.txt change

Rules for every report

- Each completed activity is linked to the KPI it affects, with the before and after value from the tracker.
- Where a change cannot be shown to cause a movement (seasonality, Google updates), the report says so instead of claiming credit. Google update dates are checked against the confirmed update list before any traffic change is attributed.
- Items requiring client approval and items requiring developer action are listed separately at the top, with a due date, so nothing waits unnoticed.

11. Requirements From the Client

Work starts in Week 1 once the "Required immediately" items are provided. The audit shows the site is served through Cloudflare; the CMS, hosting platform and developer are not yet known and are the first questions below.

Required immediately (Week 1)

Item	Needed for
Website URL and primary domain (www or non-www)	Canonical and redirect decisions
Where the site was built and hosted; CMS or platform (WordPress, Webflow, Shopify, custom, other)	Choosing how fixes are deployed
Google Search Console access (Full user)	Baseline, indexing, sitemap, CTR work
Google Analytics / GA4 access (Viewer or Analyst)	Traffic and conversion baseline
DNS / Cloudflare access (or the contact who manages it)	Apex HTTPS fix, security headers, redirects
CMS administrator access	Metadata, schema, content edits
Website developer contact	Technical fixes, sitemap, headers
Content approval contact	Approving page rewrites and FAQs
Priority services and products; target locations and countries	Keyword and content priorities
Main competitors (3-5)	Gap analysis

Required during implementation (Weeks 2-8)

Item	Needed for
Google Business Profile access (Manager)	Local SEO, GBP audit and edits
Google Tag Manager access	Conversion and call tracking
Bing Webmaster Tools access	Bing and Copilot visibility, IndexNow

Item	Needed for
Hosting access (if not behind the developer)	Server-level headers and performance
Existing keyword research, SEO reports, analytics reports, previous agency reports	Avoid repeating work; historical baseline
Current marketing campaigns and calendar	Aligning content and avoiding cannibalization
Target customer demographics and typical traveler profile	Intent, tone and content
Brand guidelines and tone of voice	Content approval speed
Advisor names, bios and credentials; photos and case stories	E-E-A-T, author markup, citation-worthy content
Partner and affiliation details (Four Seasons, Signature, ASTA)	Entity markup, authority outreach

Optional but recommended

Item	Benefit
Domain registrar access	DNS fallback and domain verification if Cloudflare access is limited
Call-tracking and CRM access (e.g. lead source reports)	Linking organic visits to booked revenue
Review platform access (Google, Tripadvisor, Trustpilot)	Review responses and review-generation workflow
Social profile access	Entity consistency and brand-mention checks
A Semrush plan with API units	Keyword, competitor and backlink data (the connected account has no units left)

Work that cannot start without access

Blocked work	Requires
Ranking, impressions and CTR baseline; indexing validation; sitemap resubmission	Search Console
Traffic and conversion baseline; organic-lead KPIs	GA4 (and GTM for new tracking)
Apex HTTPS fix, security headers, redirects	Cloudflare / DNS / hosting
Metadata, schema, FAQ and content changes	CMS admin or developer
GBP audit and local KPIs	Google Business Profile
Bing and Copilot indexing work	Bing Webmaster Tools
Keyword research, competitor gap and backlink analysis at scale	Semrush API units or an equivalent paid data source

12. Responsibilities: Our Team vs. Client

Area	Our team	Client
Audit, strategy, prioritization	Own and maintain	Review and approve
Tracker and reporting	Build, update weekly, report monthly	Review; flag changes in business priorities
Technical fixes	Specify exactly what to change; test and verify	Developer or Cloudflare admin implements, or grants access
Metadata, schema, internal links	Write and implement (where CMS access is given)	Approve within 3 business days
Content (rewrites, FAQs, new articles)	Research, draft, optimize, add schema	Provide advisor expertise and facts; approve; confirm accuracy of travel claims, partner statuses and prices

Area	Our team	Client
Local SEO	Audit, optimize, manage citations and review workflow	Provide GBP access; respond to reviews or approve replies
Authority building	Outreach, link research, digital PR drafts	Supply partner introductions and press assets; approve outreach
AI visibility (AEO / GEO)	Test, measure, optimize	Provide original insights, named experts, accurate facts
Monitoring	Daily, weekly and monthly checks	Report site changes, launches and campaigns in advance

13. Dependencies and Potential Risks

Risk or dependency	Effect	Mitigation
Delayed access to Search Console, GA4, Cloudflare or CMS	Baseline and fixes slip; 30-day plan moves	Access checklist in Week 1; escalate on day 3
Slow developer response	Technical fixes (HTTPS, headers, sitemap) delayed	Single developer contact; fixes written as copy-ready tickets
Slow content approval	Month 2 content slips	3-business-day approval window; batch reviews
Apex HTTPS result is sandbox-specific	Task 2 becomes a no-op	Re-test from 3 networks before any change
Audit used raw HTML, not rendered pages or field data	Some issues (CWV, JS rendering, mobile) not yet visible	Run rendered crawl and CrUX in Weeks 1-2 and update the plan
Google algorithm updates and seasonality	Traffic moves for reasons unrelated to our work	Compare to confirmed update dates; use year-over-year where possible

Risk or dependency	Effect	Mitigation
AI answers change daily	Citation counts are noisy	Fixed question set, repeated weekly, tracked as a trend
Travel claims and partner statuses must stay accurate	Compliance and brand risk	Client approval on all factual claims and prices
Semrush API units exhausted	No keyword, competitor or backlink data from that source	Add units or use Search Console and an alternative paid source
Site redesign or platform change mid-project	Rankings can drop if URLs or schema change	Client notifies us before launches; redirect and schema checklist

14. Expected Outcomes

We expect measurable improvement in visibility and lead quality inside 90 days, and compounding growth over 6-12 months; we do not guarantee rankings. SEO and GEO results lag the work by weeks to months, so the first 30 days show up mainly as cleaner technical health and metadata, and CTR gains on rewritten pages.

- **30 days:** baselines for search, traffic, Core Web Vitals, local and AI visibility; all metadata, schema, redirect and header fixes live; the tracker and reporting running.
- **90 days:** higher CTR and impressions on destination and service pages; expanded and answer-ready content; first featured-snippet and AI-citation gains; local profile fully optimized; first quality links from partner and industry sources.
- **6 months:** a content hub with 50-70 pages, rankings on a broader keyword set, growing organic leads, consistent AI citations for brand and core destination queries.
- **Long term:** a durable, documented system where every change is tracked and tied to results, and where Lorraine Travel's heritage and expertise are reliably recognized by both search engines and AI systems.

15. Recommended Next Steps

1. **Approve this proposal** and confirm the 30-day start date (proposed 2026-10-06).

2. **Send the Week 1 access list** (Section 11, "Required immediately"): Search Console, GA4, Cloudflare / DNS, CMS, developer contact, content approver.
3. **Answer the platform questions:** where the site is built and hosted, and who maintains it.
4. **Verify the bare-domain HTTPS result** by opening <https://lorrainetravel.com> on a normal network and telling us whether it loads.
5. **Name the 3-5 competitors** and the priority services and destinations.
6. **Kick-off call (30 minutes)** to confirm owners, approval turnaround and the weekly update day.
7. **We deliver by 2026-10-12:** the live tracker, the baseline report plan and the first weekly update.